Rails knows that all these inputs should be part of the person hash because you called `fields_for` on the first form builder. By specifying an `:index` option you're telling Rails that instead of naming the inputs `person[address][city]` it should insert that index surrounded by [] between the address and the city. This is often useful as it is then easy to locate which Address record should be modified. You can pass numbers with some other significance, strings or even `nil` (which will result in an array parameter being created).

To create more intricate nestings, you can specify the first part of the input name (`person[address]` in the previous example) explicitly:

```
<%= fields_for 'person[address][primary]', address, index: address do
|address_form| %>
  <%= address_form.text_field :city %>
<% end %>
```

will create inputs like

```
<input id="person_address_primary_1_city"
name="person[address][primary][1][city]" type="text" value="bologna" />
```

As a general rule the final input name is the concatenation of the name given to `fields_for`/`form_for`, the index value and the name of the attribute. You can also pass an `:index` option directly to helpers such as `text_field`, but it is usually less repetitive to specify this at the form builder level rather than on individual input controls.

As a shortcut you can append [] to the name and omit the `:index` option. This is the same as specifying `index: address` so

```
<%= fields_for 'person[address][primary][]', address do |address_form|
%>
  <%= address_form.text_field :city %>
<% end %>
```

produces exactly the same output as the previous example.

8 Forms to External Resources

Rails' form helpers can also be used to build a form for posting data to an external resource. However, at times it can be necessary to set an `authenticity_token` for the resource; this can be done by passing an `authenticity_token: 'your_external_token'` parameter to the `form_tag` options:

```
<%= form_tag 'http://farfar.away/form', authenticity_token:
'external_token' do %>
  Form contents
<% end %>
```

Sometimes when submitting data to an external resource, like a payment gateway, the fields that can be used in the form are limited by an external API and it may be undesirable to generate an `authenticity_token`. To not send a token, simply pass `false` to the `:authenticity_token` option:

```
<%= form_tag 'http://farfar.away/form', authenticity_token: false do %>
  Form contents
<% end %>
```

The same technique is also available for `form_for`:

```
<%= form_for @invoice, url: external_url, authenticity_token:
'external_token' do |f| %>
  Form contents
<% end %>
```

Or if you don't want to render an `authenticity_token` field:

```
<%= form_for @invoice, url: external_url, authenticity_token: false do
|f| %>
  Form contents
<% end %>
```